MACROS AND VBA PROGRAMMING

The term “macro” essentially refers to a set of instructions or codes created to prompt Excel to execute a specific action. These instructions can be manually written or recorded. Recording a macro is akin to saving a phone number in your cell phone: initially, it must be dialed and saved manually, but afterwards, you can simply press a button to call the desired number. Similarly, a macro must first be written by inputting the desired actions, and once recorded, it can be executed by pressing a simple button.

The codes written for macros are known as Visual Basic for Applications (VBA).

In this chapter, we will introduce the concept of macros and VBA programming, exploring how this tool can automate recurring processes in Excel.

MACROS BENEFITS

Macros make it easier to deal with various issues and tasks frequently encountered while working in Excel, specifically:

- **Elimination of repeating tasks**
  Some tasks require repetition monthly. Examples include updating reports, data, and pivot tables. Macros enable automation of these processes, saving time by making them automatic.

- **Reduced error bar**
  This is particularly true when upcoming deadlines must be introduced, or constant changes are required. In these cases, recording a macro makes the process easier, reducing the chance of making errors.

- **Improved browsing**
  Another advantage of macros is related to the ability to enhance the intuitiveness of Excel use, even for the less experienced users. Macros can dynamically format and print worksheets, navigate to specific sheets in the workbook, or save the document to a designated location. This feature proves particularly beneficial when collaborating in a team environment where not all users possess advanced Excel skills.